

Deploying CD3 on another machine

CD3 runs as a small **web server on a computer**; the Meta Quest 3 opens it over the **same Wi-Fi network**. There is no cloud/website to set up — you copy the project to the computer that will run it, then launch it with one double-click.

These steps work on both **Windows** and **macOS**.

Part A — Package it (done once, on the machine that has the project)

1. Make a **zip of the project folder**, but **leave out** these folders if they exist (they are large and/or machine-specific and get rebuilt automatically):

- `node_modules/`
- `dist/`
- `.vite/`
- `.git/`
- `.stfolder/`

Everything inside `public/` (the videos, audio, models, textures) **must stay in** — that's the content the app plays.

2. Get that zip onto the new computer (USB drive, file share, cloud download — whatever is easiest).
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Part B — Set up the new computer

1. **Install Node.js.** Go to <https://nodejs.org>, download the **LTS** installer for the operating system, run it, and accept all the defaults. (Same step on Windows and macOS. You only do this once per computer.)
2. **Unzip the project** somewhere easy to find, like the Desktop. Avoid putting it inside a synced folder (Dropbox/OneDrive/Syncthing) or a system folder.
3. **Launch it:**

Windows

- Double-click `start.bat`.
- If a blue "Windows protected your PC" box appears: click **More info** → **Run anyway**.
- The first time the server starts, **Windows Defender Firewall** will ask for permission — click **Allow access** (otherwise the Quest can't connect).

macOS

- **Right-click** `start.command` → **Open**, then confirm **Open** in the dialog. (Right-click → Open is only needed the very first time; after that you can double-click.)
- If it refuses to run, open **Terminal**, drag the project folder in to get its path, and run once:

```
chmod +x "/path/to/start.command"
```

then try again.

4. A terminal/console window opens and shows:

- **Installing dependencies...** (first run only, can take a few minutes)
- **Building...**
- **Starting server.**

When it's running it prints a couple of URLs. Note the **Network** one — it looks like **`https://192.168.x.x:5173`**.

Leave this window **open** — closing it stops the server.

Part C — Open it on the Quest 3

1. Make sure the **Quest 3 is on the same Wi-Fi network** as the computer.
2. In the Quest's browser, type the **Network** URL from above (**`https://192.168.x.x:5173`**).
3. You'll get a security warning because the server uses a self-signed certificate — this is expected. Tap **Advanced** → **Proceed**.
4. Tap **ENTER VR**.

Troubleshooting

- **Quest can't load the page / "can't connect":**
 - Confirm both devices are on the **same Wi-Fi** (not a guest network).
 - Windows: re-check that you clicked **Allow access** on the firewall prompt. (You can re-trigger it by closing the window and running **`start.bat`** again.)
- **Security/certificate warning in the browser:** expected — tap **Advanced** → **Proceed** (Quest) or **Advanced** → **proceed** (desktop). It only nags the first time per device.
- **To stop the server:** close the terminal/console window.
- **Re-running is safe:** double-clicking the launcher again just rebuilds and restarts. Dependencies only reinstall if something changed.
- **Quick desktop check (optional):** on the computer itself, open **`https://localhost:5173`** in a browser — you should see the scene and an **ENTER VR** button. (VR won't actually start on a desktop, but this confirms the server works.)